

First Pre-Board Examination – 2024-25

Class X

English (Language & Literature - 184) SET 1

Time Allowed: 3 hours

Maximum Marks: 80

General Instructions:

1. The question paper contains three sections - Reading, Writing & Grammar and Literature.
2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.

SECTION-A READING SKILLS (20 MARKS)

1. Read the following text.

(10)

(1) Listening is the ability to accurately receive and interpret messages in the communication process. One of the greatest gifts any of us can ever receive is the gift of listening. It is also one of the greatest gifts we can ever give. Unfortunately, it appears to be a lost art. We live in a world where everyone is talking but few are listening. What often passes for listening is simply one person pausing to collect their thoughts for their next soliloquy.

(2) Hearing refers to the sounds that you hear, whereas listening requires more than that: it requires focus. Listening means paying attention not only to the story, but how it is told, the use of language and voice, and how the other person uses his or her body. In other words, it means being aware of both verbal and non-verbal messages. Your ability to listen effectively depends on the degree to which you perceive and understand these messages.

(3) Listening is a difficult task. Like every skill, the more you do it, the better you get. Listening can be developed through practice or lost if not used regularly. Good listeners focus on what they are hearing. They pause to think about what they've heard before responding. They ask questions because they want to know the answers, not just to keep the conversation going.

(4) So often, we are distracted with other things. We try to listen while continuing to work on the computer or watch television. To be fully present means we eliminate these distractions and focus exclusively on the other person. It takes great effort to be fully in the moment, leaning forward, with your ears and heart open. Words are only part of the communication. Sometimes we need to experience the other person's feelings to really understand. We need to listen with our heart as well as our mind. We must repeat back what the other person has said. When we do this-and do it accurately-we communicate what we understand. It also gives us an opportunity to recalibrate our understanding if we have misunderstood something. Plenty of people are good talkers. Few are good listeners. If you develop the latter skill, you will find yourself invited into amazing conversations that wouldn't otherwise happen.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage.

- i. Based on your understanding of the passage, what, according to the author, can be described as "lost art"? Answer in about 40 words. (2)
- ii. Complete the sentence appropriately.
The author is disappointed that pausing to collect their thoughts is often considered as _____. (1)
- iii. Why does the author consider listening more than just hearing? Rationalise your response in about 40 words. (2)
- iv. From the sets (1)-(5) below, identify two sets of words that are opposite in meaning to each other. (1)
1. Amazing - Incredible
 2. Perceive - Overlook
 3. Experience - Wisdom
 4. Exclusively - Partially
 5. Interpret - Clarify
- A. 1 and 3
B. 3 and 4
C. 2 and 4
D. 1 and 5
- v. Complete the sentence appropriately.
Our ability to listen effectively depends on the _____. (1)
- vi. "To be fully present" in a conversation means _____. (1)
- A. constantly ask questions
 - B. to clear distractions and give our full attention
 - C. to distract the speaker
 - D. to change the topic of conversation
- vii. To repeat back what the other person has said gives us _____. (1)
- A. a chance to counter the speaker's claim
 - B. a way to intimidate the speaker
 - C. a way to distract ourselves from a topic
 - D. a chance to recalibrate our understanding if we have misunderstood something
- viii. Which of these statements is false? (1)
- A. Good listeners focus on what they are hearing.
 - B. Listening is a skill that needs practice.
 - C. We don't need to experience the other person's feelings to really understand.
 - D. Listening is one of the greatest gifts one can ever give to someone.

2. Read the following text.

(10)

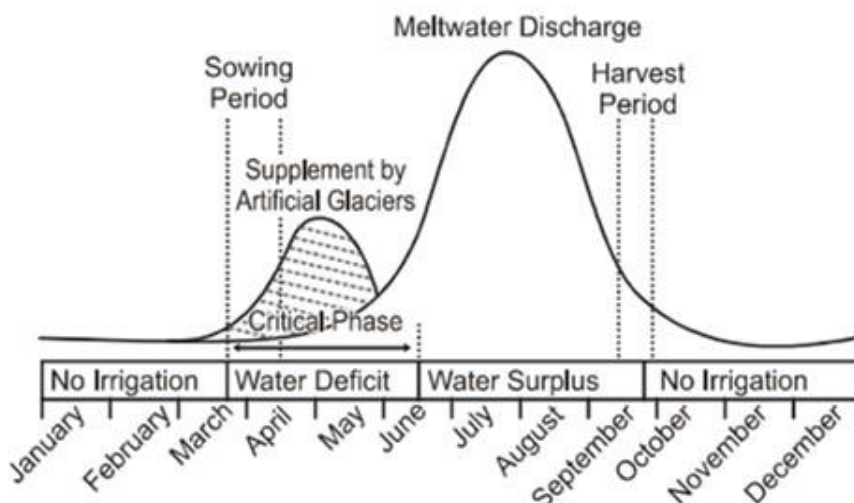
1. Necessity is indeed the mother of invention. When areas in and around Leh began to experience water shortages, life didn't grind to a halt. Why? Because a retired civil engineer in the Jammu and Kashmir Government came up with the idea of artificial glaciers.
2. Ladakh, a cold desert at an altitude of 3,000-3,500 meters above sea level, has a low average annual rainfall rate of 50 mm. Glaciers have always been the only source

of water. Agriculture is completely dependent on glacier melt, unlike the rest of river/monsoon-fed India. But over the years, with increasing effects of climate change, rainfall and snowfall patterns have been changing, resulting in severe shortage and drought situations. Given the extreme winter conditions, the window for farming is usually limited to one harvest season.

3. It is located between the natural glacier above and the village below. The one closer to the village and lowest in altitude melts first, providing water during April-May, the crucial sowing season. Further, layers of ice above melt with the increasing temperature, thus ensuring continuous supply to the fields. Therefore, farmers have been able to manage two crops instead of one. It costs about 150,000 and above to create a glacier.

4. Fondly called the glacier man, he has designed over 15 artificial glaciers in and around Leh since 1987. In recognition of his pioneering effort, he was conferred the Padma Shri by The President of India.

5. There are a few basic steps followed while creating an artificial glacier. River or stream water at high altitude is diverted to a shaded area of the hill, facing north, where the winter sun is blocked by a ridge or a mountain range. At the start of winter i.e., in November, the diverted water is made to flow on sloping hills facing distribution channels. Stone embankments are built at regular intervals which impede the flow of water, making shallow pools which freeze, forming a cascade of ice along the slope. Ice formation continues for 3-4 months resulting in a large accumulation of ice which is referred to as an 'artificial glacier'.



Based on your understanding of the extract, answer the questions below:

- Infer one reason for the following, based on information in paragraph 1. (1)
Areas in and around Leh began to experience water shortage but life didn't grind to a halt.
- Select from the passage the appropriate option to fill in the blanks: (1)
Agriculture is completely dependent on _____ unlike the rest of river/monsoon-fed India.

- a. rainfall pattern
 - b. climate change
 - c. glaciers melt
 - d. extreme winter conditions
- iii. Write any two steps followed while creating the glaciers. (2)
- iv. List two reason why artificial glaciers seem the best option. (2)
- v. Complete the following analogy correctly with a word/phrase from paragraph
icing: cake:: layers: _____ (1)
- vi. Select the correct option to complete the following sentence: At the start of winter the diverted water is made to flow _____. (1)
- a. on sloping hills facing distribution channels.
 - b. on high altitude.
 - c. on ice-cold water level.
 - d. on mountain range.
- vii. Fill in the blank by selecting from the passage the correct option: (1)
The _____ have been the only source of water in areas in and around Ladakh.
- a. glaciers
 - b. rivers
 - c. streams
 - d. water springs
- viii. The word 'located' in paragraph 3 means _____. (1)

SECTION-B WRITING SKILLS AND GRAMMAR (20 MARKS)

3. Complete ANY TEN of twelve of the following tasks, as directed. (1×10=10)

- i. Fill in the blank to complete the opening line of a formal letter:

Dear Mr. Chen,

We would like to inform you that the new policy will be _____ effective from the start of next month.

A) implemented B) rejected C) postponed D) disregarded

- ii. Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line.

When Saina Nehwal land in Hyderabad, her face was radiant of joy and happiness.

Option	Error	Correction
A.	land, was	landed, were
B.	when, land	as, landed
C.	land, of	landed, with
D.	was, of	were, with

iii. Priya asked the following question to her colleague, Dinesh.

"Will the sales report be ready by Friday?"

Report Priya's question correctly.

iv. Fill in the blank using correct option.

_____ can tell apart the twins. They are not identical.

- A. Anyone
- B. Each
- C. None
- D. Few

v. Fill in the blank with correct option:

The report read, "There _____ be heavy rainfall due to western disturbances over the Arabian Sea."

- A. should be
- B. must be
- C. will be
- D. ought to be

vi. Choose the correct option to complete the given sentence.

Karen _____ to dye her hair every 2 months.

- A. likes
- B. like
- C. liking
- D. has liked

vii. Choose the correct option to complete the given narration.

Sandeep said, "Wow! This is wonderful."

Sandeep exclaimed with _____

- A. excitement that that was wonderful
- B. joy that that is wonderful
- C. wonder that is it wonderful
- D. surprise that was it wonderful

viii. Choose the correct option to complete the sentence:

Karthik has penned _____ book titled, 'The Ashes of the Prey'.

- A. the
- B. a
- C. an
- D. It

ix. Identify the error in the given sentence that shows grandmother and grandson relation and supply the correction.

My grandmother and I were good friends. He used to wake me up early and get me ready for the school.

Use the given format for your response.

ERROR	CORRECTION

x. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option.

The teacher gave _____ (every / each / either) of the students a piece of paper.

xi. Fill in the blank with the correct option.

Priya looks tired. She _____ working in the sun since 7 am.

- A. will
- B. had been
- C. has been
- D. is

xii. Fill in the blanks:

We are living in a world _____ every girl wants to be a diva and every boy desires to be called a dude.

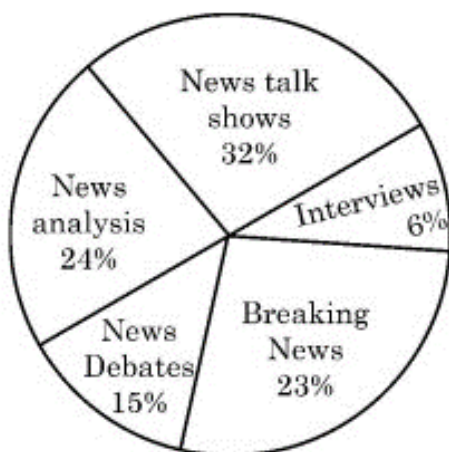
- A. by
- B. that
- C. where
- D. the

4. (A) You are Geetu a resident of Shanti Nagar, Bengaluru. You have just shifted to this new city and require a few furniture items and kitchen appliances for your house. Write a letter of order to Home and More, Mall road, Bengaluru placing an order for the same. (5)

OR

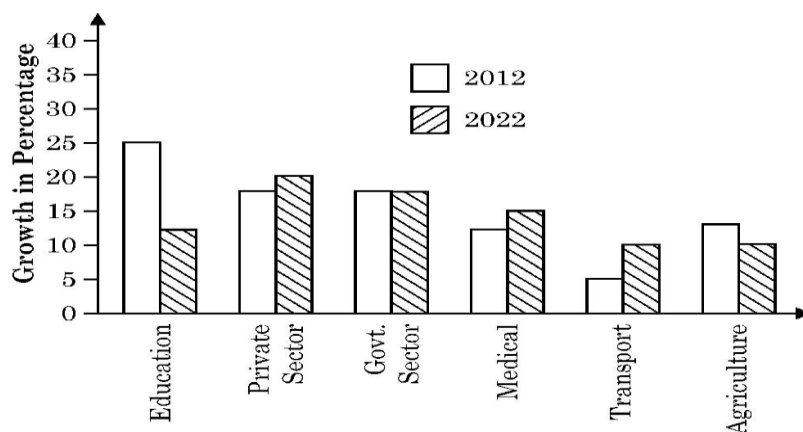
(B) You are Chetan, an IT Professional of Hyderabad. You want to raise awareness about the rising incidences of cyber-crimes. Write a letter to the editor of Cyber magazine "Info news", highlighting the issue and suggesting measures to prevent such happenings. (5)

5. (A) The increase in the number of news channels is indicative of their growth in popularity in terms of viewership. Write a paragraph analyzing the given pie chart on what viewers like watching in news channels. (100 - 120 words) (5)



OR

- (B) Write an analytical paragraph based on the double bar graph showing the percentage growth in different sectors in a developing country from the year 2012 to 2022. (5)



SECTION-C LITERATURE (40 MARKS)

6. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two given.

(A) Marriage gifts are meaningless without the sweet bread known as the bol, just as a party or a feast loses its charm without bread. Not enough can be said to show how important a baker can be for a village. The lady of the house must prepare sandwiches on the occasion of her daughter's engagement. Cakes and bolinhas are a must for Christmas as well as other festivals. Thus, the presence of the baker's furnace in the village is absolutely essential.

- i. In Goan village, what is meaningless without the sweet bread 'bol'? (1)
 - a) Birthday parties
 - b) Holi celebration
 - c) Wedding gifts
 - d) All the occasions
- ii. Find the word in the extract which means 'celebration meal'. (1)
 - a) Charm
 - b) Occasion
 - c) Engagement
 - d) Feast
- iii. The extract uses the phrase 'loses (its) charm'. Which of the following meaning is **INCORRECT** with respect to the word 'charm'? (1)
 - a) Form
 - b) Beauty
 - c) Appeal
 - d) flaw
- iv. What makes the presence of a baker's furnace in a Goan village indispensable? Write your answer in 40 words. (2)

OR

(B) "I returned another to you exactly like it. And it has taken us ten years to pay for it. You can understand that it was not easy for us who have nothing. But it is finished and I am decently content."

Mme Forestier stopped short. She said, "You say that you bought a diamond necklace to replace mine?"

"Yes. You did not perceive it then? They were just alike."

- i. 'You' in the first line is _____. (1)
 - A. Mme Loisel
 - B. Mr. Loisel
 - C. Mme Forestier
 - D. Mme Ramponneau
- ii. 'It' in the first line of the extract is referring to _____. (1)
- iii. Meaning of word 'content' is _____. (1)
 - A. Things
 - B. Satisfied
 - C. Worried
 - D. regretted
- iv. What took Loiseles ten years, and why? Elaborate your answer in about 40 words. (2)

7. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two given.

(A) Read the extracts given below and answer the questions that follow:

My head is full of whispers which
tomorrow will be silent.
Listen. The glass is breaking.
The trees are stumbling forward
into the night. Winds rush to meet them.
The moon is broken like a mirror,
its pieces flash now in the crown
of the tallest oak.

- (i) Why would the whispers be silent tomorrow? (1)
- (ii) The forest undergoes tremendous transformation overnight. Discuss with reference to the poem "The Trees" (2)
- (iii) Which word in the stanza means the same as 'quiet'? (1)
- (iv) Which poetic device has been used in the last line 'its pieces flash now in the crown of the tallest oak.' (1)
 - a) Simile
 - b) Alliteration
 - c) Imagery
 - d) Personification

OR

(B) *But if it had to perish twice,
I think I know enough of hate
To say that for destruction ice
Is also great
And would suffice.*

- i. The poem is a _____, put across by the poet. (1)
 - a) powerful warning
 - b) heart-felt apology
 - c) earnest appeal
 - d) vengeful threat

- ii. The statement/ phrase which is self-contradictory or paradoxical in the above lines is _____. (1)
- iii. Pick the option that is NOT TRUE about the poet according to the extract. (1)
The poet _____
 a) Is inclined to believe that the world would most likely end with fire.
 b) Has heard divided opinions about the way the world would end in all likelihood.
 c) Preaches love and kindness to combat the spread of hate among all.
 d) Declares the power of ice to be as destructive as that of fire.
- iv. Figure out two potential reasons for the destruction of the world stated in the poem "fire and ice" and their implied meaning or vices discussed in the poem. (2)

8. Answer ANY FOUR of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. (3×4=12)

- i. State two ways in which the oppressor and the oppressed are similar, according to Mandela.
- ii. How is the Coorgi tradition of courage and bravery recognized in modern India?
- iii. "*There is a great difference between divine love and human love.*" Justify the statement with reference to the poem '*For Anne Gregory*'.
- iv. How does the boy sense his first loss and first responsibility?
- v. What was the reason behind Rajvir's excitement?

9. Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. (3×2=6)

- i. Why does Valli refuse to look out of the window on her way back?
- ii. Why did Matilda not like to visit her rich friend?
- iii. Describe Ausable's make-believe story of the balcony?

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. (6)

(A) How does Amanda tackle the nagging nature of her parents? Explain with examples from the poem. What values does it portray about Amanda?

OR

(B) "Don't you worry, Pitaji! In your old age I will serve you and mother." Through the statement the narrator wants to highlight moral values Bholi was imbued with. Based on the reading of the lesson, what made Bholi aware of the rights and how did she use them?

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. (6)

(A) Scientists contribute to make the world a better place. Griffin is an antithesis to this statement. Justify.

OR

(B) Give a brief character sketch of Ebright's mother.
